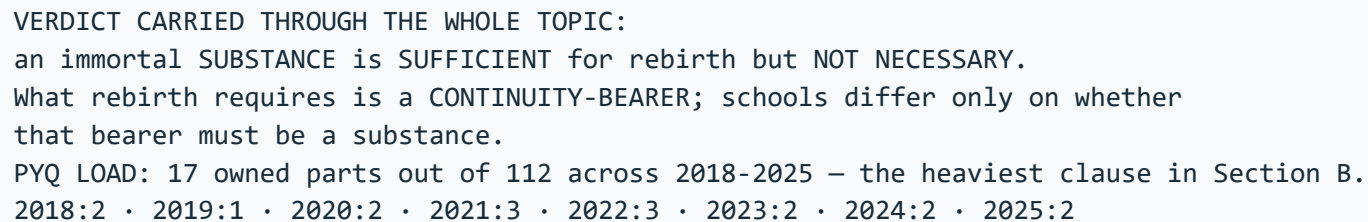


COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM – 24 PANELS

Read top to bottom. Each panel is data-complete: premises, named critics, replies and verdict.



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/32: Six survival terms that are not synonyms

TERM	CLAIM MADE	OWNER / FATAL MERGE
IMMORTALITY	a subject is deathless	Plato, Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism / with resurrection
SURVIVAL	something of the person continues after death	the weaker neutral claim / with immortality
REBIRTH punarjanma / punarbhava	karmically renewed becoming in a beginningless series	the WIDER term; the only correct one for Buddhism / with reincarnation
REINCARNATION (re-enfleshed)	a SUBSTANTIAL soul re-enters flesh	Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism / applied to Buddhism
RESURRECTION	God re-constitutes the whole embodied person; ONE life	Judaism, Christianity, Islam / "rebirth in heaven"
LIBERATION	exit from the series; SEVEN non-identical destinations	every Indian school / treated as one state

MERGE ANY TWO AND THE SCRIPT CAPS AT ABOUT 50%.

Sanskrit registers the range: punarjanma (rebirth) · punarahvrtti (return) ·
punarbhava (re-becoming) · samsara (the wandering itself).

THE THREE STEMS BUILT ON THIS BENCH:

- necessity for REBIRTH -> 2022 Q5(c); 2025 Q7(c)
- necessity for LIBERATION -> 2024 Q6(a)
- presupposition of RELIGION -> 2020 Q5(b)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/32: Five models of the person, five kinds of survival

MODEL	SURVIVAL IT ALLOWS	ITS OWN PRESSURE
SUBSTANCE DUALISM immaterial thinker	disembodied soul persists	interaction; what individuates souls
HYLOMORPHISM soul = form of body	resurrection of the embodied person	how the SAME person is re-constituted
BUNDLE / NO-SELF series without owner	causal or psycho- logical continuity	who is responsible; who is reborn
EMBODIED PERSON psychophysical unity	re-creation or resurrection only	replica and duplication problems
INDIAN SUBSTANTIAL SELF (atman / jiva)	transmigration of an enduring self	no past-life memory; evidence

FOUR CRITERIA OF PERSONAL IDENTITY – THEY ANSWER DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

BODILY CONTINUITY same living organism ... fails outright at death

PSYCHOLOGICAL / MEMORY memory, character circular, fallible, branchable

SOUL-SUBSTANCE one enduring subject ... unobservable; individuation hard

CAUSAL CONTINUITY causal descent "neither same nor wholly other"

HOW WE TELL = bodily + psychological WHAT MAKES IT SO = substance + causal

Noticing this division of labour is a top-band move.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/32: Hick's replica and the duplication objection

STAGE 1 a person disappears here and an exact psychophysical replica
| same body-pattern, same memories, same character – appears elsewhere
| ordinary criteria would in practice treat this as the same person

STAGE 2 the same thing happens at the moment of death

STAGE 3 the replica appears not elsewhere on earth but in a DIFFERENT SPACE,
a resurrection world

HICK'S CLAIM: for every purpose that matters – memory, character, recognition,
responsibility – this IS the same person.

DUPLICATION OBJECTION

if God can make ONE replica, God can make TWO
two replicas cannot both be numerically identical with the original
therefore either the criterion is not identity, or identity depends on the
accident that no rival was produced
HICK'S REPLY : restrict the case to a UNIQUE replica; ordinary criteria are then met
REJOINDER : the bare POSSIBILITY of duplication shows the criterion tracks
QUALITATIVE SIMILARITY, not NUMERICAL IDENTITY

STATUS CONTROL: the replica is a THOUGHT-EXPERIMENT DEFENCE of the coherence of
resurrection identity. It is NOT evidence that anyone survives.

Source: John Hick, Philosophy of Religion / Death and Eternal Life.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/32: Plato in the Phaedo, arguments 1 and 2

ARGUMENT 1 – FROM OPPOSITES (CYCLICAL)

PREMISE opposites come to be from opposites: larger from smaller,
weaker from stronger, waking from sleeping
APPLY being dead comes from being alive; by symmetry being alive
must come from being dead
CONCLUDE souls exist in some state between deaths, or the supply of
the living would exhaust itself
ASSESS the pattern fits qualities admitting DEGREE, not existence and
non-existence; and it yields a cosmic balance-sheet, not the
survival of THIS soul

|

ARGUMENT 2 – FROM RECOLLECTION (ANAMNESIS)

PREMISE we judge sensible things – two sticks – to be DEFICIENTLY equal
STEP to judge a deficiency one must already possess the standard,
Equality itself, which no sense-experience supplies
CONCLUDE the soul acquired that standard before embodiment;
learning is recollection
EXAMPLE equal sticks never perfectly instantiate Equality, yet we judge
their shortfall by a standard not derived from them alone
ASSESS establishes PRE-EXISTENCE ONLY – which is why Plato must pair it
with the cyclical argument to close the post-mortem direction

DIRECTIVE CONTROL: "critically examine Plato's a priori proofs" (2023 Q6(a), 20m)
= FOUR SEPARATE MINI-ASSESSMENTS, never one summary with one general complaint.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/32: Plato in the Phaedo, arguments 3 and 4

ARGUMENT 3 – FROM AFFINITY

PREMISE two kinds of thing: composite, visible, changing, perishable;
and non-composite, invisible, stable, imperishable
STEP the body resembles the first, the soul the second
CONCLUDE the soul is akin to the indissoluble, hence itself indissoluble
ASSESS Plato presents this as LIKENESS, with more caution than summaries
suggest; resemblance to the imperishable does not entail
imperishability, and simplicity is assumed rather than proved

|

ARGUMENT 4 – THE FINAL ARGUMENT: THE FORM OF LIFE

PREMISE some things bring a Form with them wherever they go:
fire brings heat, snow brings cold
STEP soul brings LIFE wherever it is
STEP what essentially brings a Form cannot admit that Form's opposite
CONCLUDE soul cannot admit death; it is deathless and indestructible
ASSESS the inference from "cannot admit the opposite" to "cannot cease"
needs a bridge: fire does not become cold, but fire GOES OUT.
The argument shows a soul cannot be a DEAD soul; the critic asks
why it may not simply cease to exist

WHAT EACH ARGUMENT ACTUALLY BUYS

- 1 persistence through the transition, both directions (weak analogy)
- 2 PRE-EXISTENCE only
- 3 likeness to the indissoluble
- 4 essential predication, with an unbridged step to indestructibility

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/32: Simmias inside the dialogue, Kant outside it

SIMMIAS' OBJECTION – THE SOUL AS ATTUNEMENT (HARMONY)

the soul is an attunement of bodily elements, as the tuning of a lyre is of its strings; when the instrument is destroyed the attunement perishes, however "divine and beautiful" it was

|

PLATO'S TWOFOLD REPLY

- (1) recollection shows the soul existed BEFORE the body – but an attunement cannot precede the instrument it tunes; so the two doctrines are incompatible and Simmias must give one up
- (2) attunements admit of degree and never oppose their own components; the soul RULES the body, opposing appetite and desire, which no attunement does

NOTE: the harmony objection is the ancient ancestor of every modern brain-dependence argument. Omitting Simmias is the standard band-loss on 2023.

KANT – THE PARALOGISMS OF PURE REASON

the "I think" that accompanies all representations gives a FORMAL UNITY of consciousness, not knowledge of a simple persisting SUBSTANCE
rational psychology mistakes a condition of thought for an object of knowledge
CONSEQUENCE: immortality cannot be theoretically demonstrated

RELOCATION : in the second Critique it returns as a POSTULATE OF PRACTICAL

REASON, required by the moral law's demand for the complete good

CONTROL: Kant does NOT claim the soul does not exist. He denies that it is a knowable substance. This relocation is exactly what 2020 Q5(b) invites.

INDIAN PARALLEL, USED CAREFULLY: atman (Vedanta), jiva (Jainism) and the Nyaya self are ETERNAL in their systems, and Gita 2.23 gives the canonical image – but the Indian route is scriptural and systematic, not a priori in Plato's sense. Compare CONCLUSIONS, never METHODS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/32: Five argument families and the burden shift

FAMILY	CORE REASONING	MAIN OBJECTION
SIMPLICITY / INDIVISIBILITY	an immaterial simple soul has no parts to decompose into	simplicity is not established; a simple subject could still cease
IDENTITY / CONTINUITY	stable agency, responsibility and first-person unity need a persisting subject	psychological or causal continuity may do the same work
MORAL ORDER	complete justice or the highest good requires more than one life	postulation expresses moral hope, not theoretical demonstration
DESIRE / FULFILMENT	a deep natural desire for unending fulfilment points to a possible object	desires can be frustrated or socially formed; existence does not follow
RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE / TESTIMONY	experiences read as contact with the dead or an eternal self support survival	interpretation, diversity and alternative explanations

BODY / BRAIN DEPENDENCE OBJECTION

memory, personality, agency and moral capacity vary systematically with
bodily and cerebral conditions

IT DOES NOT deductively prove that no subject survives

IT DOES shift the burden: the survivalist now owes accounts of

(i) INTERACTION (ii) INDIVIDUATION (iii) IDENTITY

GRADED CLAIM-LEVELS demonstration: NO • coherence: on some models • presupposition:
for some practices • postulate: available to practical reason.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/32: Hindu immortality – verse spine and school split

WHAT IS ETERNAL AND WHAT IS NOT

```
+-----+
| SELF (ATMAN)      eternal · unborn · indestructible |
|                   Gita 2.23 – weapons do not cut, fire does not burn, |
|                   water does not wet, wind does not wither |
+-----+
```

```
+-----+
| SUBTLE BODY       NOT the self – an INSTRUMENT. Carries dispositions |
| (suksma-sarira)   (samskara / vasana), mind, senses, vital breath |
+-----+
```

```
+-----+
| GROSS BODY        discarded like worn-out garments (Gita 2.22) |
+-----+
```

VERSE SPINE: 2.22 garments (rebirth) · 2.23 indestructibility ·

9.21 return when merit is exhausted (heaven is INSIDE samsara) ·

5.4-5 convergence (balah, not panditah) · 18.66 surrender (carama-sloka).

Translations vary: paraphrase, or quote a NAMED translation. Never invent one.

FOUR ACCOUNTS OF WHAT IS DEATHLESS – "Hindu tradition" is not one position

ADVAITA non-dual awareness identical with Brahman; bondage = ignorance

VISISTADVAITA eternal individual soul, a mode (prakara) of God; communion

NYAYA-VAISESIKA .. eternal self-substance; consciousness ADVENTITIOUS; no bliss

SAMKHYA-YOGA purusa, plural contentless witness; strictly never bound

SUPPORTS OFFERED (i) continuity of the knower across waking, dream, deep sleep

(ii) moral bookkeeping across a gap longer than a life

(iii) scriptural testimony (sabda) – NAME it as a presupposition

(iv) beginninglessness (anadi), which blocks "when did it fall?"

MEMORY OBJECTION -> reply: dispositional, not episodic, continuity. Warrant contested.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/32: Karma – act plus potency, and where freedom lives

ACT + ITS UNSEEN POTENCY

adrsta (Nyaya-Vaisesika) – a quality of the self
apurva (Mimamsa) – the "not-previously-existing" capacity by which
a sacrifice produces its distant result

BOTH EXIST TO SOLVE ONE PROBLEM: how a past act produces a future effect
across a temporal gap.

THE THREEFOLD LEDGER

+-----+		
SANCITA	the whole accumulated store, not yet ripening	
(stored)	-> DESTROYED by liberating knowledge	
+-----+		
PRARABDHA	the portion already ripening: this birth, this body, this span	
(fructify)	-> NOT cancelled by knowledge; runs its course	
+-----+		
AGAMI	what present action is now generating	
(future)	-> the liberated agent accumulates none	
+-----+		

^

FREEDOM ACTS HERE + effort (purusakara) works on agami and, through knowledge,
on sancita – NEVER on prarabdha.

NOT FATALISM

fatalism: what happens is fixed and effort is idle
karma : fructifying karma fixes the CONDITIONS, not the response;
present action generates future karma, so acting is the point;
the agent is both inheritor and author
FORMULA : effort (purusakara) WITHIN destiny (daiva) – the hand dealt is
inherited, the play is not
niskama-karma (desireless action) USES the law rather than escaping it

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/32: Karma – administration, postulate test, costs

WHO ADMINISTERS THE LAW?

NON-THEISTIC ROUTE

Buddhism · Jainism · Mimamsa
the law is SELF-REGULATING
no judge required; moral order is
built into how things work

|
|

+-----+

|

THEISTIC ROUTE

Nyaya · Visistadvaita · Dvaita
God is SUPERINTENDENT (karmadhyaksa)
who RATIFIES and dispenses the fruit
God does not DECIDE that cruelty
deserves suffering; God ensures the
fruit is delivered

NAMING THIS FORK turns a description of karma into a philosophical answer,
and it is exactly what 2021 Q8(b) "essential postulate" is testing.

POSTULATE TEST – REMOVE KARMA AND FOUR COMMITMENTS FAIL

- (1) DISTRIBUTION of fortune becomes arbitrary; the tradition's answer to unequal suffering collapses
- (2) REBIRTH loses its rationale – nothing would require a further life
- (3) LIBERATION loses its content – no bondage to be freed from
- (4) RITUAL INJUNCTION loses efficacy in the Mimamsa framework

A postulate is not merely believed: its REMOVAL DISABLES the rest of the system.

COSTS

- (a) UNVERIFIABLE – the links
are not observable
- (b) VICTIM-BLAMING RISK – present
suffering read as past fault
- (c) GOD-AND-LAW PROBLEM – God
redundant or subordinate

CONTROL: never omit (b) from a karma answer.

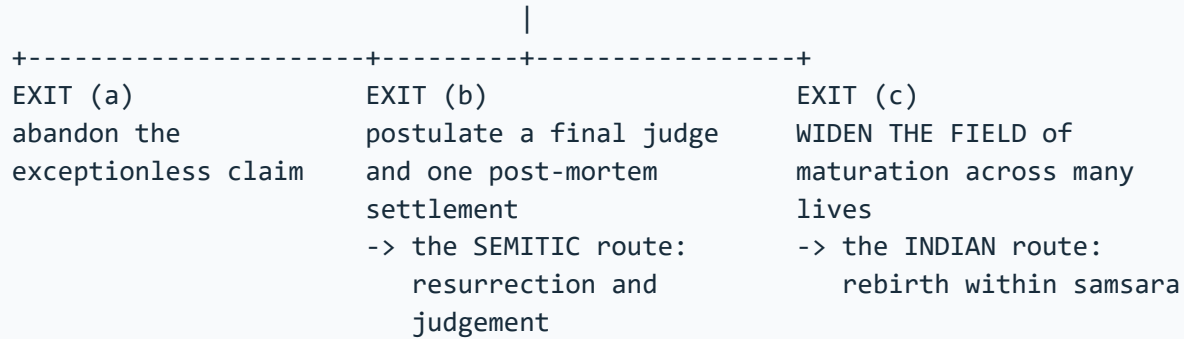
REPLIES

shared with every eschatology; not a special
defect of karma
explanatory karma licenses NO social judgement;
the duty of compassion is untouched
the theistic schools make God ADMINISTRATOR,
not AUTHOR, of desert

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/32: Rebirth – the fit-problem and its three exits

FACT : many acts plainly do not mature within one lifetime

GAP : the good suffer, the cruel prosper, and infants suffer before they
can have acted at all



REBIRTH IS EXIT (c). THAT IS ITS PHILOSOPHICAL SIGNIFICANCE (2023 Q7(b)).

WHAT REBIRTH THEREBY CONTRIBUTES

- (i) preserves an EXCEPTIONLESS moral law against the evidence
- (ii) explains INITIAL INEQUALITY: birth-conditions are consequences,
not impositions
- (iii) secures BEGINNINGLESSNESS (anadi) – no "original fault" to explain,
as there is in a Fall narrative
- (iv) gives LIBERATION its content by supplying something to be freed from

VEHICLES OF CONTINUITY, SCHOOL BY SCHOOL

Advaita / Visistadvaita ... subtle body (suksma-sarira): mind, senses, breath
Nyaya-Vaisesika the eternal self, bearing adrsta
Samkhya-Yoga linga-sarira, a product of prakrti – STRICTLY it is
PRAKRTI that transmigrates, not purusa
Jainism the jiva with adhering karmic matter
Buddhism causal continuity of aggregates; NO vehicle-substance
COSTS: regress explains each birth by an earlier one, never the series as a whole;
no past-life memory; moral hazard. Gita 9.21: even heaven is within samsara.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/32: Buddhist rebirth without a permanent self

THE FOUR-STEP ARGUMENT

(1) ALL CONDITIONED FACTORS ARE IMPERMANENT

|

(2) NO AGGREGATE (skandha: form, feeling, perception, formations, consciousness) IS A PERMANENT SELF

|

(3) CRAVING (tr̥sna) AND KARMIC FORMATIONS (samskara) CONDITION FUTURE CONSCIOUSNESS

|

(4) THEREFORE CONTINUITY OCCURS WITHOUT AN UNCHANGING OWNER

|

REBIRTH (punarbhava) IS SECURED; A SOUL IS NOT REQUIRED

Mechanism: dependent origination (pratityasamutpada).

DENIED

an unchanging, independent,
permanent self
a substance that owns experiences
a self that transmigrates intact
ANATMAN IS NOT NIHILISM: a middle course between an eternal self and annihilation.

NOT DENIED

the conventional person, who acts and is addressed
the reality of experience and moral consequence
rebirth itself – Buddhism AFFIRMS re-becoming
the causal descent of the later from the earlier

ILLUSTRATIONS – NEVER PROOFS

FLAME -> FLAME the second lamp is lit from the first. Same fire? No.

Unrelated fire? Also no. (the Milindapanha uses the lamp)

MILK -> CURD continuous transformation; no stage identical with another,
yet nothing imported from outside

RESPONSIBILITY OBJECTION: if no same agent persists, who receives the fruit?

REPLY: responsibility requires CAUSAL CONNECTEDNESS, not identity of substance.

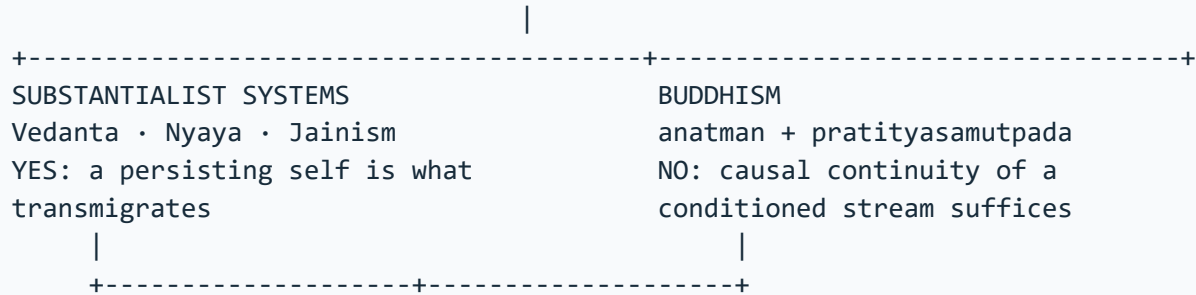
The later stream is NEITHER THE SAME NOR WHOLLY OTHER. Ordinary practice already accepts this: the adult answers for the youth.

RESIDUE (concede it): critics answer that causal descent may be thinner than

OWNERSHIP – this pressure is genuine and unresolved.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/32: The modal verdict rail

CLAIM UNDER TEST: "Immortality of Soul is a necessary postulate for rebirth."



ONE COUNTER-EXAMPLE DEFEATS A NECESSITY CLAIM

VERDICT: an immortal soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth, NOT NECESSARY.
What rebirth requires is a CONTINUITY-BEARER, and the dispute is only about whether that bearer must be a substance.

SECOND PRESSURE, FROM INSIDE THE SUBSTANTIALIST CAMP

Samkhya-karika 62-63: strictly NO PURUSA is bound, released or transmigrating;
it is PRAKRTI who binds herself, transmigrates and releases herself.
So even a school with an eternal consciousness denies that IT undergoes rebirth.

THE SAME RAIL, APPLIED TO LIBERATION (2024 Q6(a))

ROBUSTNESS TEST: a conception of liberation is robust if it fixes

- (i) what bondage is (ii) what is liberated
- (iii) what the terminus is (iv) why the terminus is final

Buddhism satisfies all four WITHOUT an immortal soul.

VERDICT: rebirth (or an equivalent bondage-HISTORY) is effectively necessary;
immortality of a SUBSTANTIAL soul is not.

TEMPLATE LINE: "Immortality of a substantial soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth but
not NECESSARY: Buddhism secures re-becoming through causal continuity alone."

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/32: The liberation parity bench – seven destinations

TERM	SCHOOL	WHAT ENDS	WHAT REMAINS	CONSCIOUSNESS?
MOKSA (release)	Advaita	ignorance (avidya)	Brahman alone	YES – self- luminous, non-dual
MOKSA (release)	Visista- dvaita	karmic bondage	eternal jiva WITH God	YES – personal, in communion
APAVARGA (cessation)	Nyaya- Vaisesika	pain AND its conditions	the self- substance	NO – no bliss, no awareness
KAIVALYA (aloneness)	Samkhya- Yoga	non-discrim- ination	purusa, isolated	YES – pure and CONTENTLESS
LIBERATION siddhahood	Jainism	karmic matter	perfected omniscient jiva	YES – the four infinitudes (ananta- catustaya)
NIRVANA (extinguish)	Buddhism	craving, ignorance, suffering	NOT stated as a self	neither "survival" nor "annihilation"
RESURRECT- ION	Semitic	death	the embodied person	YES – embodied, before God

FOUR STRUCTURAL QUESTIONS THE BENCH ANSWERS

identity / communion / cessation / isolation / perfection – which is it?

is INDIVIDUALITY preserved? (sublated only in Advaita)

is CONSCIOUSNESS present? (absent only in Nyaya apavarga)

is it attainable WHILE ALIVE? (yes in Advaita and Samkhya-Yoga)

TERMINOLOGY TRAP: kevala in JAINISM = OMNISCIENCE; kaivalya in SAMKHYA =

CONTENTLESS ISOLATION. Same syllable, opposite content.

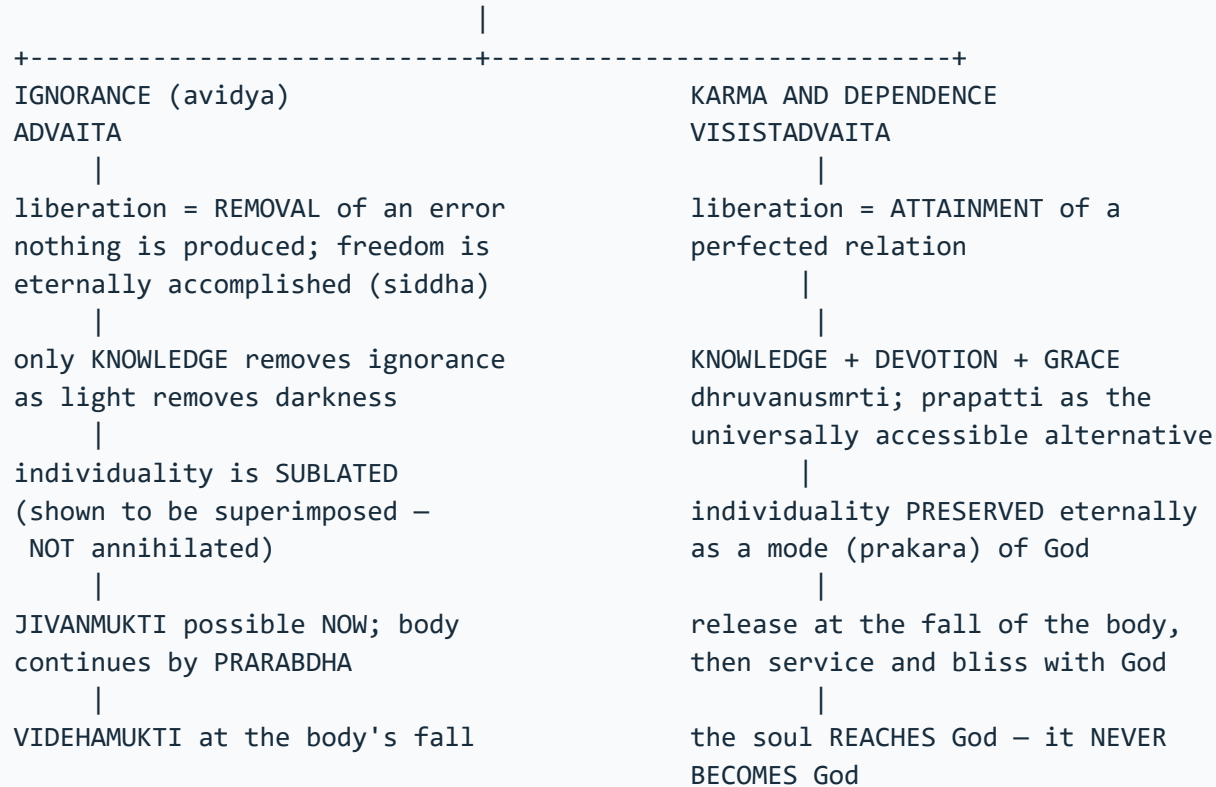
POSITIVE PERFECTION vs MERE CESSATION: Advaita and Jainism are fulfilment-rich;

Nyaya is cessation-only; Buddhism refuses both annihilation and hedonic models.

Reply to "cessation is unattractive": Nyaya offers freedom FROM suffering, not experiential luxury; promising more would be dishonest about its metaphysics.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/32: Vedanta – one fork, many consequences

WHAT IS BONDAGE?



ADVAITA'S PREPARATORY LADDER

ritual action and worship (upasana) -> purity of mind (citta-suddhi)

-> fourfold qualification (sadhana-catustaya: viveka, vairagya, the six inner accomplishments, mumuksutva)

-> sravana - manana - nididhyasana

SAMKARA REJECTS jnana-karma-samuccaya-vada: knowledge and ritual action do NOT jointly produce liberation.

ROLE OF KNOWLEDGE (2021 Q6(b) second obligation): on the removal model knowledge is not one contributory cause among others but the SOLE OPERATIVE CAUSE, because the obstacle is cognitive. Everything else qualifies or purifies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/32: Embodied liberation and the real-agent question

WHY THE BODY REMAINS AFTER LIBERATING KNOWLEDGE

knowledge destroys SANCITA (stored) and AGAMI (future) karma

PRARABDHA has already begun to ripen and RUNS ITS COURSE

IMAGE: the potter's wheel continues to spin after the potter's hand is withdrawn
at its exhaustion the body falls -> VIDEHAMUKTI

OBJECTION: if ignorance is destroyed, why does empirical activity continue?

REPLY : distinguish destroyed BONDAGE from residual embodied MOMENTUM;

the residue is located in the body-mind complex, not in the knower

REJOINDER: critics say a trace of ignorance is smuggled back under another name

CROSS-SCHOOL CONTROL: Samkhya faces the same phenomenon and explains it

DIFFERENTLY – SK 67 attributes the continuing body to the momentum of the GUNAS,
not to karma; SK 68 gives videha-kaivalya at the body's fall. Shared image,
different metaphysics.

2022 Q7(b): CAN LIBERATION BE CONCEIVED WITHOUT A REAL AGENT?

ADVAITA – YES, AND IT MUST BE

agency belongs to the empirical individual, which is superimposed

at the ultimate level (paramarthika) there is no agent, no bondage and hence

no one who is literally liberated

the tradition itself says bondage and release are stated "from the standpoint
of ignorance"

VISISTADVAITA – NO

an unreal agent cannot have real bondage, real striving, real devotion,

or a real reward; liberation must happen TO someone, so the jiva is

eternally real

HONEST VERDICT: each position pays a price. Advaita must explain how an unreal
individual undertakes a real discipline; Visistadvaita must explain how a really
distinct soul is nonetheless WHOLLY dependent on God.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/32: The Jain ladder – soul and bondage

JIVA (soul)	eternal · conscious · uncreated · NO creator God
	intrinsic nature = ANANTA-CATUSTAYA: infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and energy
	CO-EXTENSIVE with the body it occupies, like light filling a room – extension is a MODE of the soul during bondage

PASSIONS (kasaya):	anger · pride · deceit · greed
	make the soul "sticky"
ASRAVA	INFLOW of fine karmic matter (karma-pudgala)
BANDHA	BONDAGE – matter binds to the soul, obscuring the four infinitudes. Analysed by NATURE, DURATION, INTENSITY, QUANTITY

SAMVARA	STOPPAGE – vows, carefulness, restraint, non-violence:
	no new inflow
NIRJARA	SHEDDING – austerity (tapas) destroys accumulated karma
KEVALA-JNANA	OMNISCIENCE manifests while still embodied
	(manifested, NOT produced – it was only obscured)
MOKSA / SIDDHAHOOD	final disembodied perfection

IMAGE: dust clings to an OILY body. The oil is passion; without it the dust does not adhere.

INTERACTION OBJECTION: how can non-material consciousness bind with material karma?

REPLY: extension and embodiment are MODES of the soul during bondage; the jiva is not an unextended Cartesian thinker.

COST: the reply buys intelligibility by weakening immateriality – a substance neither cleanly material nor cleanly spiritual.

PLACEMENT: Jain liberation PERFECTS INDIVIDUALITY – neither Advaitic identity nor Buddhist cessation without a self. 2022 Q8(b) has TWO nouns: soul AND bondage.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 19/32: Nyaya-Vaisesika cessation – the chain and apavarga

NYAYA-VAISESIKA – THE CHAIN AND ITS REVERSAL

FALSE KNOWLEDGE -> DEFECT -> ACTIVITY -> BIRTH -> SUFFERING

TRUE KNOWLEDGE of the categories and of the self removes false knowledge;

the chain then unwinds link by link to ABSOLUTE CESSATION OF PAIN

APAVARGA = pain AND the qualities that sustain embodied experience END

Consciousness is ADVENTITIOUS – it arises only when the self is conjoined with mind, senses and body – so the released self exists WITHOUT consciousness, pleasure or bliss

OBJECTION: indistinguishable from stone-like insentience; who would want it?

REPLY : the school offers the END OF A DEFECT, not a reward. Its value is negative and complete: no pain can arise again, because the conditions for ANY experience have ended

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 20/32: Samkhya – two principles and one misattribution

SAMKHYA – TWO PRINCIPLES, ONE MISATTRIBUTION

PURUSA plural · inactive · attributeless PURE CONSCIOUSNESS · witness (saksin)
by nature already isolated (kevala)

PRAKRTI one · unconscious · active · constituted by the three gunas

BONDAGE IS NOT A REAL BOND but AVIVEKA: prakrti's states are MISATTRIBUTED
to consciousness

SK 1 threefold suffering: adhyatmika (self) · adhibhautika (other beings) ·
 adhidaivika (natural and cosmic), and the failure of ordinary and
 ritual means to end it permanently

SATKARYAVADA effects pre-exist in their cause: evolution is TRANSFORMATION of
prakrti, not creation; consciousness cannot be a product of the
unconscious, hence purusa is distinct

SK 62-63 NO PURUSA is bound, released or transmigrating – PRAKRTI binds,
transmigrates and releases herself. THE HIGHEST-VALUE ITEM HERE

SK 67 potter's wheel – the body persists on residual momentum

SK 68 videha-kaivalya at the fall of the body

LIBERATION = VIVEKA-KHYATI (discriminative discernment); prakrti then ceases
to display herself to that purusa. RESULT = KAIVALYA, aloneness

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/32: Yoga – practice, the non-creator Isvara, and three objections

YOGA – SAME METAPHYSICS PLUS A PRACTICE AND AN ISVARA

YS 1.2 yoga = citta-vrtti-nirodha (restriction of mental modifications)

YS 1.3 then the seer abides in its own nature

YS 2.3 five klesas: avidya · asmita · raga · dvesa · abhinivesa
(avidya is the FIELD of the rest)

YS 1.24 ISVARA IS A SPECIAL PURUSA untouched by klesa, karma, vipaka, asaya –
teacher of the ancient teachers, object of isvara-pranidhana.

HE IS NOT A CREATOR. Yoga = theism WITHOUT creation

YS 4.29 dharma-megha-samadhi

YS 4.34 KAIVALYA = pratiprasava (counter-flow) of the gunas, now empty of
purpose for purusa; equivalently citi-sakti established in its own nature

ASTANGA: yama · niyama · asana · pranayama · pratyahara · dharana · dhyana ·
samadhi – samprajnata to asamprajnata

THREE OBJECTIONS -> REPLIES -> COSTS

plurality of purusas -> difference shown by birth, death, experience ->

Advaitins call this question-begging, since those differences belong to prakrti

why does prakrti act? -> "for the sake of purusa"; milk flows for the calf ->

a purpose in the unconscious is exactly what Nyaya objects to

is contentless liberation desirable? -> Samkhya DENIES kaivalya is bliss; it is

the ENDING of threefold suffering -> an unattractive terminus, accepted for

the sake of consistency

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 22/32: Devotion as a pathway – textual base and typology

TEXTUAL BASE

Gita 18.66 carama-sloka: abandon all dharmas, take refuge in Me alone

Gita 9.22 the Lord secures what the exclusively devoted lack

Gita 9.32 accessibility of the path

Bhagavata 7.5.23 NINE LIMBS (navadha bhakti), IN ORDER:

sravana (hearing) · kirtana (praising) · smarana (remembering) ·

pada-sevana (service at the feet) · arcana (worship) · vandana (salutation) ·

dasya (servitude) · sakhya (friendship) · atma-nivedana (self-offering)

Narada Bhakti Sutra / Sandilya Bhakti Sutra: supreme love / supreme attachment
to Isvara. Do NOT attach a date or an author-identification

TYPOLGY (marks lie in the distinctions)

para (higher, disinterested) <-> apara / gauni (preliminary, ritual-supported)

vaidhi (scripturally ruled) <-> raganuga (spontaneous, Gaudiya)

saguna (Tulsidas, Surdas, <-> nirguna (Kabir, Nanak, Dadu)

Mirabai) -> shows bhakti needs a PERSONAL FOCUS,
not an iconic form

five bhavas: santa · dasya · sakhya · vatsalya · madhurya

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 23/32: Devotion – systematic positions, grace and effort, evaluation

SYSTEMATIC POSITIONS

- RAMANUJA bhakti = dhruvanusmrti (steady loving recollection);
PRAPATTI / saranagati as the equally efficacious, universally
accessible alternative; liberation finally by GRACE
- MADHVA jnana-purvaka-sneha (affection PRECEDED by knowledge);
prasada decisive; taratamya fixes the degree
- VALLABHA pusti-marga, the path of nourishing grace, unearned by works
- CAITANYA prema-bhakti as a FIFTH and higher purusartha – the devotee may
prefer service to liberation
- ADVAITA preparatory only: citta-suddhi and one-pointedness qualify one for
jnana, which alone removes ignorance
(?) the Vivekacudamani definition – ascription to Samkara DISPUTED:
say "the Advaita tradition", never "Samkara wrote"

THE GRACE / EFFORT PROBLEM

- MARJARA-NYAYA the cat carries the kitten -> GRACE ALONE (Tenkalai)
- MARKATA-NYAYA the young monkey must cling -> GRACE PLUS EFFORT (Vadakalai)

EVALUATION CRITERIA (2018 Q7(c) says EVALUATE, not describe)

- ACCESSIBILITY highest – dispenses with Sanskrit learning and ritual
entitlement; hence the vernacular movement: Alvars, Nayanars,
Basavanna, Kabir, Nanak, Mira, Tukaram
- SUFFICIENCY sufficient and DIRECT in the theistic Vedantas;
PREPARATORY only in Advaita
- TERMINUS communion and service, not identity – sufficiency is relative
to a Vaisnava conception of the goal

INCAPACITY ARGUMENT: if bondage is beginningless the bound jiva cannot lift
itself; only grace can, and bhakti is the posture in which grace is RECEIVED.

OBJECTIONS -> REPLIES

- love presupposes duality -> Advaita AGREES and so classes it as means, not end;
the theistic Vedantas deny that identity is the goal at all
- emotionalism -> vaidhi discipline, scriptural regulation, Madhva's knowledge-first
if grace decides, effort is otiose -> the cat/monkey dispute IS the tradition's
own statement of the problem; neither side eliminates the other term
- bhakti presupposes a saguna God -> nirguna bhakti shows a PERSONAL FOCUS suffices,
BUT the objection stands against strictly non-theistic systems

VERDICT FORMULA: bhakti's significance is not emotional but STRUCTURAL – it
relocates liberation from ACHIEVEMENT to RECEPTION.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 24/32: The three-means dispute – apparatus and positions

SEQUENTIAL stages, or COMBINED? Naming the disagreement IS the answer.

THREE DISTINCTIONS THAT SEPARATE A 7 FROM A 12

- (1) DIRECT MEANS (saksat-sadhana) vs AUXILIARY AID (arad-upakaraka)
 - (2) MEANS vs QUALIFICATION (adhikara) – karma may qualify one for knowledge without being a means to liberation
 - (3) PRODUCTION MODEL vs REMOVAL MODEL of liberation
 - if moksa is a RESULT to be produced -> action can produce it
 - if moksa is the REMOVAL of an error -> only knowledge can remove it
- SAMKARA'S ENTIRE CASE RESTS ON THE SECOND
-

THE POSITIONS

PURVA-MIMAMSA	KARMA ALONE – the Veda is essentially injunctive; knowledge-passages are subordinate to ritual action. This is the purvapaksa Samkara argues against, and naming it shows why the dispute exists
SAMKARA	JNANA ALONE liberates. Moksa is not a producible effect (sadhya) but the eternally accomplished nature of the self (siddha), obscured by avidya. REJECTS jnana-karma-samuccaya-vada. Karma and upasana remain indispensable PREPARATIONS
RAMANUJA	SEQUENTIAL CULMINATION – karma-yoga purifies, jnana-yoga discloses the self as a mode of God, both flow into BHAKTI-YOGA as the direct means; prapatti is the accessible alternative. Accepts a graded samuccaya that Samkara denies
MADHVA	knowledge of the Lord's supremacy is prior; bhakti ripened from it is the means; prasada is decisive

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 25/32: The three-means dispute – text signal, objections and verdict

THE TEXT'S OWN SIGNAL

Gita 5.4-5: only the immature (balah) declare Samkhya (knowledge) and Yoga (action) to be different; one who reaches by one reaches by the other.

-> CONVERGENCE, which is why SAMKARA claimed it for jnana, RAMANUJA for bhakti, and TILAK (Gita-Rahasya) for karma.

VIVEKANANDA: four yogas (jnana, bhakti, karma, raja) matched to TEMPERAMENT – psychological, not metaphysical, pluralism.

OBJECTION: convergence is diplomatic mush – knowledge that dissolves individuality and devotion that preserves it cannot terminate in the same state.

REPLY : they converge in FUNCTION (dismantling egoic self-appropriation) and diverge in TERMINUS (identity vs communion). Say exactly this.

SECOND OBJECTION: if karma cannot liberate, why does the Gita command action?

REPLY : niskama-karma does not liberate BY PRODUCING moksa; it liberates by dismantling the agency-sense that sustains bondage.

VERDICT FORMULA: KARMA QUALIFIES · BHAKTI RECEIVES · JNANA REMOVES.

Which is DIRECT is settled by a prior question: is liberation PRODUCED or UNCOVERED?

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 26/32: Resurrection and rebirth – two strands and the grid

TWO WESTERN STRANDS OFTEN WRONGLY MERGED

IMMORTALITY OF THE SOUL (Greek/Platonic): the soul is naturally deathless and death RELEASES it from the body

RESURRECTION OF THE DEAD (Hebrew-Christian-Islamic): the person is a PSYCHOSOMATIC UNITY, so survival requires God to restore the WHOLE person; death is real and defeat is reversed only by divine act

OSCAR CULLMANN (1955), "Immortality of the Soul or Resurrection of the Dead?": the two are theologically OPPOSED, not complementary

AXIS	RESURRECTION	REBIRTH (INDIAN)
Number of lives	ONE earthly life	beginningless series
Mechanism	divine act at the end of history	karma maturing through samsara
Judge	God, in a final judgement	the karmic law itself; in Nyaya/Ramanuja God RATIFIES
Telos	restored embodied life in communion with God	EXIT from the series – moksa/nirvana/kaivalya/apavarga
Identity-bearer	person re-constituted by God (soul as form, or replica)	atman/jiva – or, in Buddhism, a causal stream
Body	ESSENTIAL; a "spiritual body" is still a body	discarded like clothing (Gita 2.22); subtle body carries dispositions
Direction of time	linear, eschatological	cyclical, with a linear exit
Moral function	accountability before a personal God	self-regulating desert, no external prosecutor

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 27/32: Identity failures both ways, and rebirth versus reincarnation

THE IDENTITY PROBLEM, BOTH WAYS

FOR RESURRECTION: the GAP PROBLEM (what exists between death and raising?) and the RE-ASSEMBLY / "CANNIBAL" objection (if matter is shared, whose atoms rise?)
AQUINAS the rational soul is the FORM of the body, securing continuity
VAN INWAGEN God PRESERVES the body (or a core) and leaves a simulacrum
HICK a unique psychophysical REPLICA with memory and character IS the same person for all purposes that matter

DUPLICATION OBJECTION -> if one replica, why not two? Hick restricts to a UNIQUE replica; critics answer that possibility of duplication already shows the criterion is not identity

FOR REBIRTH: the MEMORY OBJECTION – no recollection of prior lives.

Reply: psychological memory is not metaphysical continuity; latent samskaras and vasanas connect lives. (?) Coherent, but evidentially empty.

REBIRTH vs REINCARNATION (2019 Q8(a) DEMANDS THIS)

REINCARNATION (re-enfleshing) presupposes a SUBSTANTIAL soul re-entering a body
-> apt for Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism

REBIRTH is the WIDER, neutral term and the ONLY correct one for Buddhism's punarbhava without a transmigrating substance

Gita 9.21 (pitryana): those who exhaust their merit RETURN to the world of mortals – even heaven is a WITHIN-SAMSARA stage, not resurrection

VERDICT FORMULA: resurrection asks how a person can survive when the person is essentially embodied; rebirth asks how moral desert can be discharged when a single life is too short. NEITHER IS A VERSION OF THE OTHER, and the identity problem is unresolved on both sides – for OPPOSITE reasons.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 28/32: Anti-theistic rebirth – the three detachments

(1) KARMA WITHOUT A JUDGE

desert is discharged by an impersonal, self-regulating law
-> answers the DISTRIBUTION question without theodicy

(2) REBIRTH WITHOUT A SOUL

continuity, not substance, suffices (Buddhism)
-> defeats the NECESSITY claim

(3) LIBERATION WITHOUT GRACE

nirvana and Jain perfected omniscience need no deity and no divine favour
-> shows soteriology is not intrinsically theistic

THE TWO SYSTEMS ARE NOT ONE POSITION

	BUDDHISM	JAINISM
Permanent self?	NO – anatman	YES – eternal jiva
Creator God?	NO	NO
Karma	causal conditioning of a stream	quasi-material matter adhering to the soul
Liberation	extinguishing of craving (nirvana)	perfected omniscient individuality
Proves	rebirth needs no soul	rebirth and liberation need no God

TOGETHER they establish more than either alone: Jainism removes the GOD without removing the SOUL; Buddhism removes the SOUL without removing REBIRTH. The WHOLE structure is therefore separable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 29/32: Anti-theistic rebirth – significance, counter-pressures, limits

WHY THIS IS "PHILOSOPHICALLY SIGNIFICANT" (2018 Q&A)

it ISOLATES the explanatory work: if the same phenomena are explained without a judge and without a substance, neither is doing indispensable work

it ANSWERS DISTRIBUTION differently from theism: impersonal law explains why THIS person suffers without a divine reason for the allocation

it RELOCATES the burden: the theist must show what a judge ADDS; the substantialist must show what a permanent soul ADDS

COUNTER-PRESSURES -> REPLIES

a law with no legislator is odd -> moral causation treated as basic, as natural regularities are treated

without a self, moral ownership is unclear -> causal descent; "neither the same nor wholly other" (STRONGEST objection; concede the residue)

without grace, liberation may be unattainable for most -> graded paths and lay-adherent routes

HARD LIMITS

nastika = VEDA-REJECTING, not atheist

do NOT merge the two anti-theisms – they differ precisely on the soul

the conclusion is DETACHABILITY, never a disproof of theism

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 30/32: The directive decoder

DIRECTIVE DECODER

"Is X a necessary condition for Y?" -> modal verdict; substantialist YES,
Buddhist counter-example, exact claim
2022 Q5(c) · 2024 Q6(a) · 2025 Q7(c)

"Discuss with reference to [text/school]" -> fidelity to THAT source; the Gita
question must cite Gita verses

"Critically examine [thinker]'s proofs" -> four separate mini-assessments

"Elucidate ... and explain the role of" -> TWO obligations, both delivered

"Do you accept that ...? Discuss" -> position first, then evidence, then
the strongest contrary case

"Evaluate X as a pathway" -> criterion FIRST: accessibility,
sufficiency, terminus

"State and explain the doctrines A, B, C" -> three definitions, then relations

"Discuss the nature of A and B" -> two nouns, both delivered

"essential postulate" -> REMOVAL TEST, then price the costs

"How far is it plausible ...?" -> graded plausibility verdict

RULE: the moment a stem names a liberation term (moksa/apavarga/kaivalya/nirvana/
jivanmukti), fix that term against the PANEL 15 bench before writing anything else.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 31/32: 17-part PYQ routing and the fourteen standing traps

17 PART PYQ ROUTING, 2018-2025

2018 Q5(b) 10m anti-theistic rebirth PANEL 23
2018 Q7(c) 15m bhakti as a pathway PANEL 20
2019 Q8(a) 20m karma, rebirth, reincarnation PANELS 10, 12, 22
2020 Q5(b) 10m immortality as presupposition PANELS 8, 9
2020 Q8(c) 15m knowledge, action, devotion PANEL 21
2021 Q6(a) 20m immortality, Hindu tradition PANEL 9
2021 Q6(b) 15m Advaita liberation + role of knowledge PANEL 16
2021 Q8(b) 15m karma as essential postulate PANEL 11
2022 Q5(c) 10m necessity w.r.t. Buddhism PANELS 13, 14
2022 Q7(b) 15m liberation without a real agent PANEL 17
2022 Q8(b) 15m Jain soul and bondage PANEL 18
2023 Q6(a) 20m Plato's a priori proofs PANELS 5, 6, 7
2023 Q7(b) 15m significance of rebirth in karma PANEL 12
2024 Q5(c) 10m Nyaya-Vaisesika apavarga PANEL 19
2024 Q6(a) 20m robust conception of liberation PANELS 14, 15
2025 Q5(d) 10m jivanmukti in Advaita PANEL 17
2025 Q7(c) 15m necessity w.r.t. the Gita PANELS 9, 14

THE FOURTEEN STANDING TRAPS

- 1 do not equate immortality, resurrection and rebirth
- 2 do not say Buddhism denies continuity – it denies a permanent substance-self
- 3 do not describe Nyaya apavarga as positive bliss
- 4 do not make all Indian liberation doctrines a merger with God
- 5 do not use the flame analogy as proof
- 6 distinguish knowledge destroying ignorance from prarabdha sustaining the body
- 7 do not treat bhakti as mere emotion – achievement to reception is the point
- 8 do not say "Advaita rejects bhakti" – Advaita makes it PREPARATORY
- 9 do not answer the three-means question with "all three are equal"
- 10 do not conflate rebirth with reincarnation
- 11 do not present resurrection as rebirth in heaven
- 12 do not treat kaivalya as a synonym for moksa, or Jain kevala as Samkhya kaivalya
- 13 do not call Yoga's Isvara a creator (YS 1.24)
- 14 do not say Samkhya's purusa is bound and released (SK 62-63)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 32/32: Graded verdict ladder, mark bands and verdict templates

GRADED VERDICT LADDER

WEAK ~40% "the soul is eternal and is reborn until liberated" – all schools merged; liberation terms used as synonyms

AVERAGE ~50% correct school-wise definitions; no argument reconstruction; Buddhism handled as an exception rather than a counter-example

GOOD ~60% continuity-bearer identified per school; one objection answered; necessary/sufficient distinction still unstated

STRONG ~65-70% modal verdict precise; parity-bench distinctions live; Western comparator (Plato / resurrection) used deliberately

TOP ~70%+ all the above PLUS a discriminating distinction (production vs removal; saksat vs arad-upakaraka; SK 62-63 misattribution; replica theory) PLUS a statement of what would FALSIFY the position

MARK BANDS: 10m ~150 words · 15m ~250 words · 20m ~300 words.

PARAGRAPH PATTERN: CLAIM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION.

THREE VERDICT TEMPLATES

NECESSITY STEM "Immortality of a substantial soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth but not NECESSARY: Buddhism secures re-becoming through causal continuity alone. What rebirth actually requires is a CONTINUITY-BEARER, and schools disagree only about whether that bearer must be a substance."

MEANS STEM "All three are means of different kinds. Which is the DIRECT means is settled by a prior metaphysical question – whether liberation is produced or uncovered – and every school's answer follows from that."

LIBERATION STEM "The term names a FAMILY, not a state. Once apavarga, kaivalya, moksa and nirvana are separated, the apparent Indian consensus turns out to be a shared vocabulary covering four incompatible destinations."